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SERVICE MANAGEMENT

Version 3.5.2

Product Guide



FRONTISPIECE

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This manual relates to:

Service Management Version 3.5.2

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Glossary of Terms



Glossary

Accounting Period

A specific number of days, identified by a start and end date, which controls postings to Accounts Receivable and General Ledger.

Agreement Type

A code used to describe the duration and terms associated with a specific class of contract.

Billing Period

The period of time for which a contract is protected from a price increase.

Billing Term

The period of time for which a contract is protected from a price increase.

Branch

A sub-division of a company, a branch is an organisational unit which controls its own service operations, but shares certain data with other branches of the same company.

Call

A service job is a defined set of work at a single customer site, identified by a unique application-generated job number. It may consist of one or more job lines, that is, pieces of equipment. Each job line is treated as a separate unit of work within the job, with its own job category, fault code, customer contact name, target response date/time, status and engineer.

Company

A completely self-contained environment for Service Management operation. Each company is identified by a unique two character code.

Contract Conditions

A price entered against a piece of equipment on a contract, which overrides the price calculated automatically by the application, using the visit and supplement fees on the contract rates file. The price may be applied at contract header, or machine and peripheral levels; it may cover, for example, fixed service and visit charges, or rentals, or copies/vends rates and standing charges. A special price applies to the normal invoice term of the contract.

Contract Invoice Term

The period of time for which a contract is protected from a price increase.

Contract Type

A code used to describe the duration and terms associated with a specific class of contract.

Contract

The terms and conditions of maintenance, agreed with a customer, for the provision of service to equipment installed at a customer's site or sites.

Cover Type

This defines the equipment price to be charged for an item of equipment in contract pricing, and the charge matrix to be used in job pricing.

Delivery Address

A location where equipment is located and jobs will be carried out by field service engineers.

Division

A grouping of engineers, usually based on products, used for segregating calls.

For example, a company may have a common service call administration for two sets (divisions) of engineers, covering the same geographic area, but requiring quite different skill sets.

Engineer Report

A document, a service report or service sheet, completed by an engineer after performing a service call at a customer site. The report holds the details of labour and travel times, parts used and miscellaneous expenses. This information is

entered into Service Management through the technical reporting screens in the Engineer Work Allocation option.

Technical reporting can be made promptly, efficiently and accurately by using remote communications technology, whereby the engineer reports parts used and so on into a portable terminal. This means that information does not have to be re-keyed at all.

IN Currency

A European currency that is linked to the EURO currency with a fixed exchange rate.

Installation

One or more items of equipment located on a site.

Installation Address

A location where equipment is located and jobs will be carried out by field service engineers.

Invoice Consolidation Level

A control flag which determines the way in which invoice lines for a customer are grouped onto invoices. The levels available are 1 (account level), 2 (account/address level) or 3 (job or contract level).

When World Trade and multi-currency are active, currency breaks and tax regime changes will affect these groupings.

Invoice Frequency

A sub-division of the normal invoice term, this represents the number of months between invoices, if the contract invoice term is to be invoiced in instalments.

Invoice From And Invoice To Dates

Two dates held on contract invoice lines only, which indicate the period of time that the charge on the invoice line actually covers. This may be the full contract invoice term, or a part of it, if instalment or pro-rata invoicing is involved.

Invoice Period

The period of time for which a contract is protected from a price increase.

Invoice Term

The period of time for which a contract is protected from a price increase. It is also the number of months for which the contract is normally invoiced at any one invoicing run, for example, 6, 12 or 24 months.

Job

A service job is a defined set of work at a single customer site, identified by a unique Service-generated job number. It may consist of one or more job lines, that is, pieces of equipment. Each job line is treated as a separate unit of work within the job, with its own job category, fault code, customer contact name, target response date and time, status and engineer.

Job Line

A sub-division of a job, a unit of work to be performed on a specific piece of equipment. A job line is identified by the combination of job number/model number/serial number.

Location

A location where equipment is located and jobs will be carried out by field service engineers.

Model

A category of machine or equipment. Models exist within model sub-groups, within model groups, within divisions. The model name is usually descriptive of the equipment and is the name by which it is known to sales and customers.

Multi-Currency

The choice between multi-currency and single currency is made in the Accounts Receivable company profile. When active, sites can be invoiced in the valid General Ledger currency set on their Additional Service Details records: this is the prime currency.

The ledgers, including costs, will be maintained in base currency: converting between currencies is system-generated, in conformance with exchange rates set in General Ledger.

Next Term Ends On

The date on which the next contract invoice term to be priced will end. This date is held on the contract billing parameters.

Next Term Starts On

The date on which the next contract invoice term to be priced will start. This date is held on the contract billing parameters.

Normal Invoice Term

The number of months between invoices.

Owner

When defined against a piece of equipment, the owner is a customer who actually owns that equipment, and who may be invoiced.

Pending Invoice Line

An invoice line not yet assigned an invoice number or posted to the ledgers, which is waiting to be grouped with other invoice pending lines to form an invoice. This grouping is dependent on the customer's invoice consolidation level.

Pending Invoice Line Availability Date

A date held on each pending invoice line, which defines when the invoice line may be released for consolidation into an invoice. For in advance contract invoice lines, this will be the start date of the contract invoice term or instalment period. For in arrears contract invoice lines, this will be the end date of the contract invoice term or instalment period. For job invoice lines, this will be the date on which the line was created, that is, the pricing date.

Quotation

A set of records identical to a contract, but with a special status of quotation. This is for future development.

Remote Communications

The interaction of Service Management and a variety of hand-held terminals to pass information between the centre and field engineers. The main emphasis is on validating safe transmission and receipt of all 2-way messages.

Scheduled Visit Profile

This defines the number, type and frequency of scheduled maintenance visits, by means of relative service periods and job categories.

Serial Number

A number which, in combination with a model code, uniquely identifies a single unit to be serviced. The use of serial numbers is strongly recommended where it is practicable.

If the use of serial numbers is not practicable, then Service Management enables you to enter a quantity instead. This means that the system still has an exact record of the equipment you have at each installation, even if individual pieces of equipment cannot be identified.

Service Agreement

The terms and conditions of maintenance, agreed with a customer, for the provision of service to equipment installed at a customer's site or sites.

Service Contract

The terms and conditions of maintenance, agreed with a customer, for the provision of service to equipment installed at a customer's site or sites.

Service Period

A specific number of days, identified by a start and end date, which controls scheduling and monitoring of service jobs.

Service Report

A document, a service report or service sheet, completed by an engineer after performing a service call at a customer site. The report holds the details of labour and travel times, parts used and miscellaneous expenses. This information is entered into Service Management through the technical reporting screens in the Engineer Work Allocation option.

Technical reporting can be made promptly, efficiently and accurately by using remote communications technology, whereby the engineer reports parts used and so on into a portable terminal. This means that information does not have to be re-keyed at all.

Site

A location where equipment is located and jobs will be carried out by field service engineers.

Special Price

A price entered against a piece of equipment on a contract, which overrides the price calculated automatically by the application, using the visit and supplement fees on the Contract Rates file. The price may be applied at contract header, or machine and peripheral levels; it may cover, for example, fixed service and visit charges, or rentals, or copies/vends rates and standing charges. A special price applies to the normal invoice term of the contract.

Task

A service job is a defined set of work at a single customer site, identified by a unique application-generated job number. It may consist of one or more job lines, that is, pieces of equipment. Each job line is treated as a separate unit of work within the job, with its own job category, fault code, customer contact name, target response date/time, status and engineer.

Technical Report

A document, a service report or service sheet, completed by an engineer after performing a service call at a customer site. The report holds the details of labour and travel times, parts used and miscellaneous expenses. This information is entered into Service Management through the technical reporting screens in the Engineer Work Allocation option.

Technical reporting can be made promptly, efficiently and accurately by using remote communications technology, whereby the engineer reports parts used and so on into a portable terminal. This means that information does not have to be re-keyed at all.

Term

The period of time for which a contract is protected from a price increase.

Visit

A service job is a defined set of work at a single customer site, identified by a unique application-generated job number. It may consist of one or more job lines, that is, pieces of equipment. Each job line is treated as a separate unit of work within the job, with its own job category, fault code, customer contact name, target response date/time, status and engineer.

World Trade

The correct documentation of service parts transfers and job invoices, where more than one country is involved, within and outside the EC, is the scope of World Trade.

Service Management interfaces with it for customer, stockroom, country and item maintenance. Currencies, and differing tax regimes (that is, VAT, GST and so on) are processed specifically at invoicing, and where stock movements are involved.

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